HARTFORD PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Office of Talent and Professional Learning
960 Main Street, Hartford, CT 06103
(860) 695-8000
October 22, 2026
Shanice R. Giles
Principal, Bridgeport Avenue Elementary School
1540 Bridgeport Avenue
Hartford, CT 06106
Employee ID: HPS-22-0847
RE: Professional Development Grant Award -- 2026-2027 School Year
Dear Principal Giles,
I am pleased to confirm your professional development grant award for the 2026-2027 school year under the
Hartford Public Schools Educator Professional Growth Fund.
This grant supports certificated administrators and educators pursuing advanced degrees or approved
professional learning that directly aligns with district strategic priorities. Your continued enrollment in the Ed.D in
Educational Leadership program at Hartwick Graduate Institute has been reviewed and meets all eligibility criteria
for this award.
AWARD DETAILS
Award Amount: $2,000.00
Award Period: 2026-2027 School Year
Intended Use: Graduate tuition, required course materials, or approved conference registration directly related to
your Ed.D program
Program: Ed.D in Educational Leadership, Hartwick Graduate Institute
DISBURSEMENT SCHEDULE
Payment 1: $1,000.00
Disbursed to your school-district-linked account on file: October 22, 2026
Purpose: First-semester tuition offset
Payment 2: $1,000.00
Disbursed: February 6, 2027
Purpose: Spring 2027 tuition offset
Disbursement is made by direct deposit to your Hartford Public Schools payroll bank account on file. If your
banking information has changed, contact HR at (860) 695-8200 no later than October 30, 2026 to avoid a
disbursement delay.
GRANT CONDITIONS

1. You must remain actively enrolled in the approved program through the award period. If you take a leave of absence from your Ed.D program, you must notify the Office of Talent and Professional Learning within 10 business days and any disbursed funds not yet applied to program costs must be returned.

2. You must remain employed by Hartford Public Schools in a qualifying certificated position through June 30, 2027. If you leave the district before that date, any undisbursed payments will be forfeited.

3. You must submit a brief completion report (one page, template attached) by July 15, 2027, confirming program enrollment status, the semester completed, and how the coursework has been applied to your work in the district. Reports are retained for state reporting purposes.

4. Grant funds are considered supplemental compensation and are subject to federal and Connecticut state income tax. You will receive a W-2 supplement reflecting the total award amount. Consult a tax professional if you have questions about the tax treatment of this income.

CONTACT

For questions about this award, disbursement schedule, or reporting requirements, contact:

Melissa Okafor
Director, Educator Professional Growth Fund
Office of Talent and Professional Learning, Hartford Public Schools
Phone: (860) 695-8144
Email: m.okafor@hartfordschools.org

Congratulations on your continued commitment to your own professional growth and to the students and families of Bridgeport Avenue Elementary. The district is proud to support your work.

Sincerely,

Dr. Alicia Fernandez
Chief of Talent and Professional Learning
Hartford Public Schools

Enclosure: Completion Report Template (1 page)

cc: Personnel File, Employee ID HPS-22-0847